



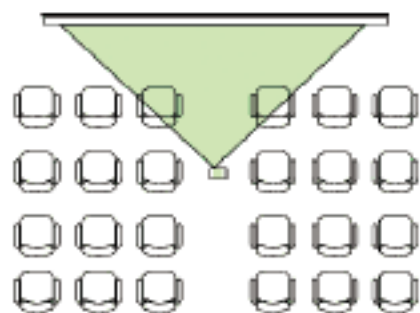
Projectors

If you're among those rare breed of people who opt for a projector over a large screen display as the display component of your home entertainment system; you know the basic merits of a projector so we'll only touch on them here. Business users need the flexibility of a huge screen; especially when conducting group meetings, large presentations and even during employee training sessions. If you're the kind of person who craves a true cinema experience or just needs a very large display for your office an LCD or plasma screen many not be a viable option. As the screen size increases such panels become prohibitively costly; while a 32-inch LCD may cost Rs 50,000, a 90-inch display could cost well over rupees three lakhs. What if you want a 130-inch display? In such cases a projector makes more sense as you can get a much larger image for a smaller price.

We discovered that these units are more multi-purpose than we initially expected; this simplifies the process of choosing one.

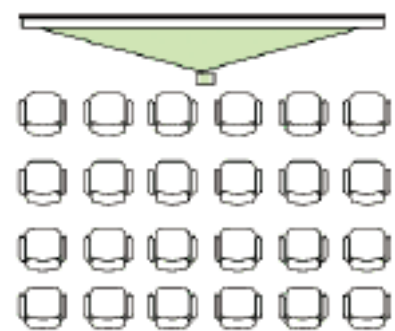
Long Throw Or Short Throw?

One of the important things to consider is what is going to be the distance between your projector and the screen. In case you have a large living room or huge hall the projector may need to be kept more than 30 feet away from the screen. In such cases you need you need a long throw projector lens; which is capable of displaying a smaller image over a longer distance. A short throw projector, on the other hand can display a larger image with a very short distance between its lens and the projector screen. Both long and short throw lenses are available for all projector models but just which one you need depends on the situation. Some users may need both in case their projector is used both inside large halls and cramped spaces.



Long Throw

For those with large rooms where the distance between the projector and screen is more than 20 feet



Short Throw

For smaller living rooms; where the distance between screen and projector is no more than 18 feet



Screens

The choice of screen also plays a significant role in your viewing experience. Generally at least 20 percent of your total budget for the projector should be allocated to the screen. A high-gain screen means the screen reflects more and is therefore perceived as being brighter; but this also results in poorer viewing angles. Lower gain screens are less bright; but viewing angles are better. It is important to reach a balance in terms of gain. Motorised screens are available too; these save you the hassle of unfurling the screen

Connects

When buying a projector please consider the connectivity options that you may need. PC D-Sub and/or DVI connectivity is important in case you need to connect your projector to a PC or notebook and a projector should ideally have at least one PC connect. HDMI is very common on higher home entertainment projectors but you may not find an HDMI port on cheaper projectors or business oriented projectors; as it is primarily a standard meant for home entertainment. Component connects are also useful for someone looking at a high quality analog video signal; give this preference over Composite connects who's output quality is not as good.



Brightness And Contrast

Although we are the first to warn users not to solely look at the manufacturers specifications and make buying decisions on the same brightness and contrast are two characteristics you should take careful notice of. The more the brightness rating (in lumens) of the bulb; the brighter your image on-screen; which is a good thing; especially if you are using a slightly longer throw projector.



High Contrast

Rich, vibrant and bright colours



Lower Contrast

The image may not be as bright, colours won't be as vivid

Resolution

The resolution of your projector is also important especially if you want a cinematic experience at home; if you are working with content at HD resolutions like 720p or 1080p then the resolution becomes even more important. For most users an XGA projector capable of 1024 x 768 pixels should suffice. Remember to look at its native resolution; and not the list of supported resolutions as this is misleading. Projectors, like LCD monitors produce the best results when run at their native resolutions. Stay away from VGA (640 x 480 pixels) or SVGA (800 x 600 pixels). An XGA projector will easily handle HD content; but there are 720p projectors that work with widescreen content (like HD content) better.



SVGA

These projectors are much cheaper than XFGA ones and are mainly for budget conscious audiences



XGA

1024 x 768 pixels is enough for most people. Text images will be a lot crisper